

Earthy = Marsy

Earthy = Venusy

But, for reasons we have already discussed — namely, the fact that identity is transitive — these three claims do not sit well together. So it appears that the psychological theory implies a contradiction.

Marsy $\neq$ Venusy



Basically the same point could be made about the version of the story on which, after the transmission to Mars, the individual who steps into the teletransporter on Earth steps back out. To tell that version of the story, we'd just need to introduce two names — Earthy-1 and Earthy-2 — for the individual on earth pre-teletransportation, and the individual who exists after the teletransportation.

It is easy enough to turn this into an argument against the psychological theory of survival.

1. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Marsy.
 2. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Venusy.
 3. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Marsy = Venusy. (1,2)
 4. Marsy $\neq$ Venusy.
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C. The psychological theory of survival is false.
(3,4)

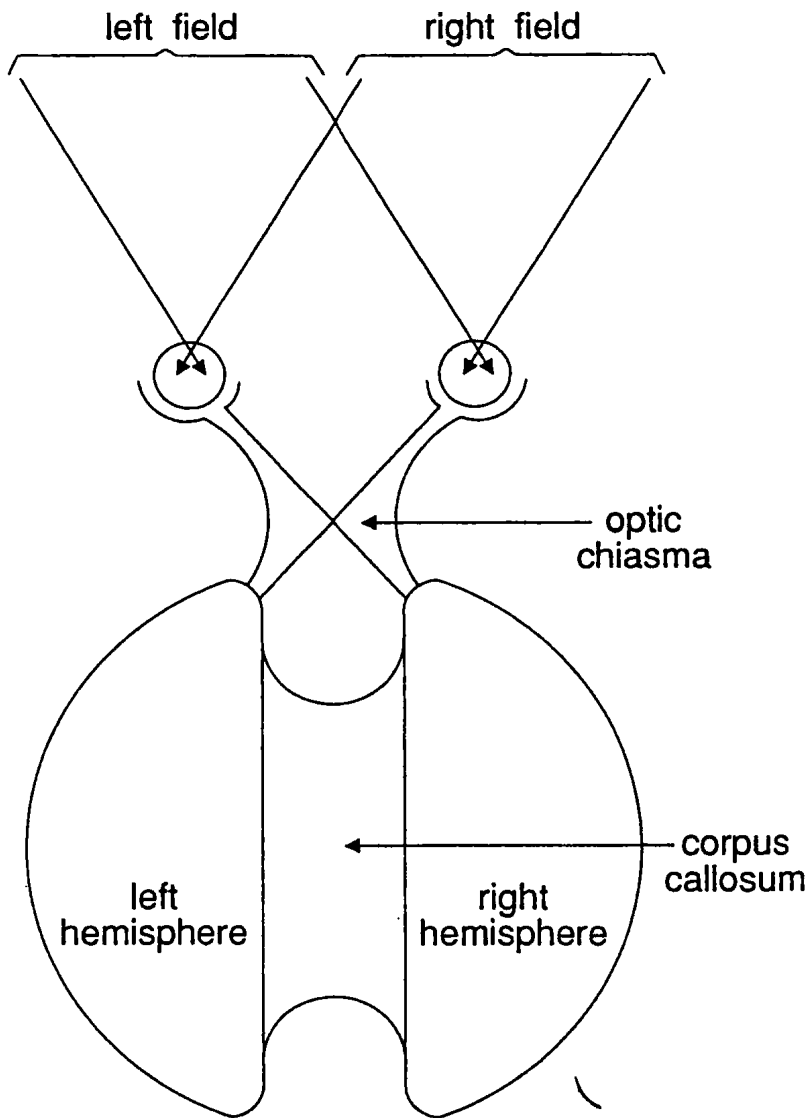
We now have three ‘pure’ views of personal identity on the table, along with the various combinations of those views.

THE TELETRANSPORTATION ARGUMENT

The results of giving sensory data to just one of the hemispheres of the brain of such a patient are striking.

Our topic today is a cluster of puzzles about identity and survival. These puzzles put pressure, in different ways, on some of true assumptions about survival we have been making so far.

One good way to test out your preferred view of survival is to think about what your view implies with respect to these three puzzles.



“... if two different words are flashed to the two half fields (e.g., ‘pencil’ and ‘toothbrush’) and the individual is told to retrieve the corresponding object from beneath a screen, with both hands, then the hands will search the collection of objects independently, the right hand picking up the pencil and discarding it while the left hand searches for it, and the left hand similarly rejecting the toothbrush which the right hand lights upon with satisfaction.”

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